



SELN Monthly Network Meeting

Key Takeaways

March 19, 2025

Overview:

- Meeting highlights included the updated Blue Book; a discussion about creating teams and partnerships, internal team structure and succession planning; a member question about language changes, and upcoming dates for the case manager eLearning course and network meetings.

Data Minute:

- StateData: The National Report on Employment Services and Outcomes, also known as “the Blue Book”, has been updated to include data from 2022.
- [The Blue Book](#) contains data from five sources including the National Survey of State Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities Agencies' Employment and Day Services (IDD survey), Rehabilitation Services Administration Case Service Report (RSA-911), the American Community Survey (ACS), the Social Security Administration (SSA) and U.S. Census and the Bureau of Labor Statistics.
- Browse previous editions of the Blue Book, read Data Notes for a more in-depth explanation of data points, and view infographics of our most important data findings at www.Thinkwork.org/statedata.
- Nine times out of ten, conversations about data within the SELN are based on data available at this site.

Discussion of Team Structure and Succession Planning:

- Paige Rose-Merrifield presented quotes collected from the 2024 SELN annual meeting bingo cards reflecting what members would value in a “dream system” and requested that members reflect on how to preserve institutional knowledge and organizational culture amid internal staffing changes to maintain team momentum and look toward succession planning. Members responded to questions about what they would have liked to support their ability to do their jobs when they were new in their positions, and what they would want to pass along to future leaders.
- Responses included a “connect the dots” diagram of agencies’ working rules, contract requirements and communication patterns; written definitions of policies and processes shared between partners; and an appreciation of the knowledge that people new to the field need to acquire before they can provide services effectively.
- When asked to reflect on and describe the symptoms of a team without these structures in place to preserve relationships and knowledge, members responded that the team would show signs of frustration, confusion and inefficient use of resources.
- Members discussed their nominations for the “Big Three” catalysts for a strong team, including such elements as effective communication, shared vision and goals, a sense of teamwork rather than individual ownership of processes or information, stakeholder involvement, and ability to partner with other state organizations.
- Members also discussed strategies to identify and address indications of internal team problems and their roles in solving them; strengthening the sense of teamwork; nurture partnerships, particularly for one-person teams; groom future leaders, and celebrating individual and team successes.

State Member Question:

- A member question addressed whether states are making changes to language in response to changing federal guidelines and priorities.
- Members are encouraged to communicate directly with each other about these questions and to approach ICI and NASDDDS team leaders with any concerns and questions, even with a simple request to talk offline.

SELN eLearning Course Reminders:

- The eLearning course is in its spring section. People may still enroll through April 4th. There will be another section before the summer begins.
- Contact Amy Huppi at amy.huppi@umb.edu for course flyers and other information and support for any case managers who want to take the course.

Upcoming MNM Dates:

- April 23, 2025: Tour of the remodeled SELN Hub.
- May 21, 2025.
- June 18, 2025.

Materials:

- [Recording](#)
- [Slides](#)